

8.1 Why Do I Need A CMS?

8.1.1 What is a CMS?

What exactly is a CMS? From Wikipedia, “a content management system is sometimes a Web application used for managing Web sites and Web content, though in many cases, content management systems require special client software for editing and constructing articles.”

Simply put, a CMS is an application that makes developing Web sites that much easier. All you will *ever* need to do is upload and install the CMS on your server! Not only is it cheaper, it also saves you time—time that can be spent giving the killer edge to your software. It is this time that will hold the key to the success of your business. Wouldn't you want to utilise it in the best possible manner?

Here, we will look at the Web Content Management Systems that will help make developing your site a more pleasant affair!

8.1.2 Advantages of PHP-Based CMSes

There are various types of Web Content Management Systems, but the two main types include PHP-based and ASP-based CMSes. PHP-based CMSes are more popular than the rest. The advantages that PHP-based CMSes enjoy over others are:

- These Content Management Systems are based on PHP, which is a *relatively* easy programming language to learn.
- PHP is cross platform, so you need not worry about the OS or hardware you're running. In most cases, it will be supported.
- PHP, like other open source Software, has a community of developers willing to resolve your queries.
- Most of these CMSes are free.
- PHP-Based CMSes are easy to modify and do not require extensive support, which is ideal for small businesses and independent developers.
- Most hosting companies support PHP, so choosing a host won't be a problem either.
- Generally, these CMSes are more secure than the others, though security largely depends upon the user.